

1.0 Homepage

Homepage

Section 1

Welcome! I’m Alicia, a nurturing player-coach design leader that leads with both conviction and care.

My design journey started about 15 years ago from my love of problem solving. I’m currently a Senior Manager, Product Design at Intuit Credit Karma leading a design team through the AI revolution. Previously I solved problems at Capital One, United income, JP Morgan Chase, and CIBC.

Contact | LinkedIn

Section 2

These principles reflect how I strive to lead every day.

Consistent	Clear	Care
I create consistency that helps teams do their best work.	I communicate with clarity so teams can move with confidence.	I lead with care because great products are built by people first.

[Learn more \(Links to Leadership\)](#)

Section 3

Select Work

[Photo 1.O_Image_1.png]

Senior Manager, Product Design | 2026

Tax & AI

Led a product design team of 5 through a winning tax season for Credit Karma and TurboTax. When workshops proved too slow to scale, built a custom Gemini AI tool used by design and product management to plan.

#Team Leadership #AI Adjacent Design #Revenue Impact

[Photo 1.O_Image_2.png]

Manager, Product Design | 2023

Monileo

Redesigned Credit Karma Money around top member pain points, heroing the metrics members cared about most. When momentum stalled, introduced a 2-week sprint model that got the team back on track.

#Product Redesign #Sprint Planning #Team Leadership

[Photo 1.O_Image_3.png]

Staff Product Designer | 2022

Orientation

Redesigned onboarding, reduced account draining and lifted key activation actions for Refund Advance customers — including +29% Direct Deposit setup and +20% self-deposit.

#Onboarding #Behavioral Design #Cross-functional

Section 4

Team Appreciation

[Carousel format starts]

Alicia is an exceptional manager, open, collaborative, and deeply invested in her team's success. She's straightforward and transparent in her communication, balancing encouragement with constructive feedback that truly accelerates growth. She pushes me

to think more strategically, ask sharper questions, and raise the quality bar in my work. Her ability to balance empathy with accountability sets a high standard for leadership.

Team Member

Alicia is an incredible leader, perhaps one of the strongest in the entire design org. She balances empathy with practicality and does a great job providing insightful design critiques or asking questions that inspire deeper thinking and thoughts. She's meticulous, has an artist's eye and I know a roadmap or excel spreadsheet hates to see her coming.

Team Member

I appreciate Alicia's efforts to elevate Design's role, especially through encouraging team-led workshops and stronger collaboration with PMs and Eng. This support has helped me feel more empowered in my work.

Team Member

Alicia is an extremely effective driver of the CK Tax design team. She raised the bar on customer empathy on the team by mentoring designers and PM's on how to use UserTesting and how to work directly with members. She also runs the design team day to day and makes sure we have a strong collaborative culture on the team and always get stuff done.

Cross-functional partner

I really appreciated your organization (e.g. weekly standup meetings and clear documentation of priorities by the owner in Figma) and partnership to resolve blockers for the team. Whether it be on Monileo carousel, CB placements, or on Instant Transfer differing opinions, you always came to the conversation prepared and open to feedback but also firm in your point of view especially when it came to advocating for the member and the member experience.

Cross-functional partner

I think I was only able to join 1 or 2 of your brainstorming session but wow! You were incredibly prepared, thoughtful, and they were a very productive use of time – I hope I can learn more from you in the future and would love the chance to work together again!

Cross-functional partner

Alicia has been an incredible design manager and an essential partner to the product team. She brings structure, clarity, and direction to the design process while also creating space for meaningful collaboration across functions. She's a strong advocate for her team and helps product managers deeply understand design needs and workflows. What stands out

most is the energy and insight she brings to every conversation. Alicia has a strong member-first mindset and always elevates discussions with thoughtful perspectives rooted in both customer empathy and product vision. She's been a key force behind the success of this year's tax season, and it's been a joy to partner with her. I'm excited to continue working with her and seeing all the impact she drives.

Cross Functional Partner

[Carousel format ends]

Section 5

[Photo 1.O_Image_4.png]

Let's chat

Contact | LinkedIn

Problem solving through design since 2011.

Charlotte, NC | Available Remote

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2.0 About

About

Section 1

I start each day with a grateful heart.

[Photo 2.O_Image_1.png]

Section 2

Life Learner, Problem Solver

I'm a lifelong learner, curious about everything. I approach my work like I approach my life, excited to learn something new to help me grow. My career started with my love of problem solving and inherent need to make things easier. I'm a big believer in identifying the right problem to solve through research and understanding the problem space.

Collaboration is my default

I love learning from everyone and value different perspectives and ways of thinking about things. Workshops are where I bring the team together to truly collaborate. I'm known for my impactful workshops filled with unique activities tailored to the audience with the goal front and center.

AI Adjacent not Replacement

I've been approaching this AI revolution like I approach everything else in my life, with curiosity. I do not believe design is dead and AI agents will replace all humans. I believe as long as we continue to design for humans, human-centered design will remain relevant, how we apply it will evolve with the breakthroughs in AI.

My leadership style

Transitioning from an individual contributor (IC) to a people manager was not an easy decision for me. Why? Because I love the work. I used to believe if I became a people manager I would be further away from the work. Although this may be true for a lot of parts, it has brought me closer to defining the work and product strategy, which are two areas I loved as an IC. I would describe my leadership style as nurturing player-coach. I care deeply about the well-being of my team above anything else, I am able to jump in and do the work, but strive to help my team grow. See [Leadership](#) [link to Leadership page].

Lover of Design

My love of design goes beyond pixels. I love creativity in all forms. I'm currently obsessed with paper crafting (I occasionally wear knitted sweaters) and interior design.

Family Oriented

My greatest gift is my family. I'm a wife to an amazing husband and mother to two wonderful daughters. I'm also a daughter, a sister, and an aunt to little people that bring me so much joy.

Section 3

My love of design goes beyond pixels.

[Photo 2.0_Image_2.png]

I love paper, notebooks, and all things stationery! I love it so much I opened my own stationery shop called Paper Worthy Company. I create handcrafted stationery products to help you grow. Check it out at paperworthy.co!

3.0 Work

Work

3.1 Select Work: Tax & AI

Select Work

Intuit is a global financial technology company that owns both consumer and business brands. Their leading brands TurboTax, Credit Karma, Quickbooks, and Mailchimp serve over 100 million customers. Over the past 4.5 years I worked for Credit Karma, a free finance platform that allows customers to monitor their credit score and access financial tools and recommendations. I served in various product design roles including as an individual contributor and people manager in a few different business areas.

In 2025 I was assigned to lead a group of 5 designers focused on experiences that led to Credit Karma members filing their taxes with TurboTax. The focus of my team included experiences related to tax tools (for example refund estimator and document checklist), entry points to TurboTax, and a Tax tab found in Credit Karma.

The Impact

Under my design leadership we had a great season.

[Chart format starts]

YTD Through 4/16

Revenue:

- Total Revenue: \$138,200,000 (ITPY 142)
 - New: \$70,400,000
 - Returning: \$67,800,000

[Chart format ends]

[Chart format starts]

YTD Through 4/16

Members:

- New: 933,700 (ITPY 130)
- Returning: 493,600 (ITPY 133)

[Chart format ends]

The Challenge

Working on Tax experiences came with a lot of nuances.

- We looked at everything through the lense of seasons and planned the experience and business around it. Tax seasons included off-season, pre-season, in-season, and post-season.
- Business goals change with time and with different segments.

Previously the team leaned heavily on a one size fits all approach when developing experiences. The only “segmentation” practice was if the Credit Karma member filed their taxes with TurboTax the previous year (new and returning).

In August 2025 the product marketing team developed a Go-to-Market Strategy that included segmentation work.

The Opportunity

Use the newly identified segments to develop in-product experiences that were hyperpersonalized.

The Approach

Understand the segments

The product marketing team developed extensive documentation about the different segments. My job included sharing this information with the design and product team as well as facilitating open discussion with our Product Marketing partner.

Bring the the team together to define

I developed a workshop which included a few activities to help develop hyperspersonalized experiences for our segments. I brought together our cross-functional team (product design, product marketing, and product management) to help define key tax areas including season definition, business goals, intent building, and experience considerations for each segment. It was so important for these key areas to be defined not just by one group, but input and consideration by different areas helping to build the product experience.

[Photo 3.1_Image_1.png]

Brainstorm experience ideas

The workshop included a brainstorming section where the team brainstormed different **experience building blocks** that could be explored for a particular segment during different times in tax seasons.

[Photo 3.1_Image_2.png]

This resulted in fruitful discussion and ideas we used to enhance the in-product experience for our members. The only problem was it took a long time to get there. The workshop took about **5 hours** spread across multiple sessions and we were only able to complete 1 segment out of the 5 we wanted to cover. If we wanted to do all 5, that would have been over **25 hours** commitment from all cross-functional partners. At the time this was a very unrealistic ask for the team.

This is when I had the idea to utilize AI.

The Real Opportunity

Develop an AI tool that will help plan experiences in-product that are hyperpersonalized to the newly identified segments.

With the help of a Senior Staff Product Designer on the team we reversed engineered the activity and developed a Gemini Gem that can be used by anyone wanting to plan future experiences.

The AI Augmented Approach

Define important info to build context

I created a google sheet that included important definitions and context including segmentation information for each segment (description, who they are, how they relate to taxes, etc).

Develop instructions

The Senior Staff Product Designer developed instructions (role and objective, response logic/trigger conditions, what to do and what not to do, triangulate factors, tone, terminology, and format) that was later added to the AI tool chosen.

Select AI Tool

We decided to go with Google Gemini. The Senior Staff Product Designer created a Gemini Gem, a custom AI assistant using the google sheet I created and instructions he developed. Being able to share easily was one of the deciding factors.

Share with Team

The Gemini Gem, AI assistant was shared with the design, engineering, and product management teams via a link to the Gem.

[Photo 3.1_Image_3.png]

The Result

The Gemini Gem, AI tool was used to help plan vision work for next season. This tool has been used by not only design but product managers to help plan future in-product experiences.

[Photo 3.1_Image_4.png]

This was a great example of how we can use AI to help accelerate work. The key to the success of this was the deep work completed cross-functionally, which was used as the foundation in the development of this AI tool.

3.2 Select Work: Monileo

Select Work

Intuit is a global financial technology company that owns both consumer and business brands. Their leading brands TurboTax, Credit Karma, Quickbooks, and Mailchimp serve over 100 million customers. Over the past 4.5 years I worked for Credit Karma, a free finance platform that allows customers to monitor their credit score and access financial tools and recommendations. I served in various product design roles including as an individual contributor and people manager in a few different business areas.

In 2023, I was put on a redesign project for the banking portion of the Credit Karma app (called Credit Karma Money). A small team was put together to focus on this very large undertaking. It included product management, product marketing, product design, engineering, product analytics, and legal council resources dedicated to the redesign.

At the time I was a manager, product design. I worked closely with my director, senior staff product designer, and a contract product designer. My responsibilities included:

- Review and provide feedback on the experience
- Help meet deadlines
- Mitigate issues that impacted velocity
- Help prep and prepare presentations for the executive committee
- Update UI if needed

[Tab section start]

Goal

Redesign Credit Karma Money to better demonstrate value to members by addressing top pain points uncovered through research and member support data.

Top Problems

Access and multi-session continuity

There's friction in navigating to Money within our app

Members want to:

- View my balance
- View transactions
- Find Credit Builder

Usability and discoverability

Important tasks require too many taps or are buried too deep in UX

- Transfer money
- Find ATMs
- Deposit a check
- Card and account numbers
- Debit card functionality

Know when something needs action

Money notifications are important and get lost in the noise, and requirement actions are not obvious when opening the app

- Declined transaction
- Transaction needs to be confirmed
- Bill payment due

Persona

- Jordan
- 25 years old
- Credit score: 520
- Bank accounts: 2
- Works at Target
- Annual salary: \$32,000
- Weekly hours: 38
- Family Life: She has a baby girl. Her finance has some medical conditions that prevent him from working in the next 6–12 months or even longer. She is now the only income provider for the family.

Approach

Address top members pain points by:

- Making the most important actions easily accessible
- Heroing the most important metric (what the member has available to spend)
- Upsell must always be tied to a member's segment and where they are in their activation journey

[Tab section end]

The Impact

Improved member experience that resulted in members being able to complete the most important tasks.

[Carousal start][Photo 3.2_Image_1.png][Photo 3.2_Image_2.png][Photo 3.2_Image_3.png][Carousal end]

Control: 512,924

Enabled: 514,086

New Direct Deposit Activations

Control 0.61%

Enabled: 0.62%

Lift: 1.85%

Credit Builder Activation

Control 0.53%

Enabled: 0.58%

Lift: 9.86%

Checking first funding

Control 0.75%

Enabled: 0.76%

Lift: 1.29%

Open first Savings funding

Control 0.60%

Enabled: 0.74%

Lift: 23.84%

Open Savings

Control 0.78%

Enabled: 1.01%

Lift: 28.52%

The Challenge

The first few weeks were great. There was momentum and the team made significant progress in a short period of time. They were able to get out a beta version of the main overview tab for members who had an active direct deposit on iOS. But then things started to slow down and priorities were not clear.

My boss came to me with this challenge: "How might we keep the momentum of the team and focus on the most important things?"

The Approach

How I approached handling this challenge.

Got the team's perspective

I talked to the team to understand why in their opinion things have slowed down and priorities are not clear. We were a very close knit group that had awesome communication.

Made sense of what I learned

I synthesized what I learned into key buckets: ownership, due dates, and prioritization.

Provided a suggested solution

Based on what I learned, I suggested implementing a 2 week sprint model which included ownership, due dates, and prioritization. This was what I believed would hold the team accountable.

Developed the solution

I worked with product management, design, and engineering leadership to narrow down a list of top priorities in order of importance. I created a sprint document that outlined what was expected when and a google sheet that included the sprint plan (date, topic, design owner, engineer owner, product owner, and roadblock notes).

Rolled it out to the team

I rolled it out to the whole team via a team meeting. I communicated clear expectations, owners, topics, and due dates and who to escalate to when/if challenges arrived.

The Result

We got back on track delivering items on a 2 week frequency and identifying road blocks. Everyone knew what they were responsible for and who to go to if they needed to escalate. Tapping into a tried and true process not only helped motivate the team, but it gave the executive team confidence we were working on the right things with velocity.

Testimonials

About my leadership on Monileo

Alicia, I'm really happy we had a chance to work together on MG6 and a little bit for Monileo follow-up work. I really appreciated your organization (e.g. weekly standup meetings and clear documentation of priorities by the owner in Figma) and partnership to resolve blockers for the team. Whether it be on Monileo carousel, CB placements, or on Instant Transfer differing opinions, you always came to the conversation prepared and open to feedback but also firm in your point of view especially when it came to advocating for the member and the member experience. You also are a strong communicator and were constantly working to ensure everyone was clear on priorities and that we were aligned as a team. – **Product Manager Partner**

Strategy & Functional Expertise (Alicia's strengths): Staying true to the vision of Monileo and not letting it devolve into a surface that is not member centric. This involved a lot of resilience and tough conversations to appease PMs with business goals. – **Engineer Partner**

3.3 Select Work: Orientation

Select Work

Intuit is a global financial technology company that owns both consumer and business brands. Their leading brands TurboTax, Credit Karma, Quickbooks, and Mailchimp serve over 100 million customers. Over the past 4.5 years I worked for Credit Karma, a free finance platform that allows customers to monitor their credit score and access financial tools and recommendations. I served in various product design roles including as an individual contributor and people manager in a few different business areas.

In 2022, my squad focused on onboarding new Credit Karma Money members. I worked as a Staff Product Designer helping to create and improve onboarding experiences.

The Challenge

I worked on the banking part of the app. Every tax season there was an opportunity for TurboTax customers to become Credit Karma Money members through offers. A large number of TurboTax customers took advantage of **Refund Advance**. A Refund Advance (RAD) is a zero-fee, 0% APR short-term loan that members can get (if approved) once they file their taxes with Turbotax. It gives members fast access to cash—often within minutes of the IRS accepting their e-filed return—without impacting their credit score. The amount is based on their refund amount. In order for them to get **RAD** they had to open a Credit Karma Money Spend account (checking account).

In the 2021 tax season, most TurboTax customers who took refund advance and opened a Credit Karma money account: drained their accounts (immediately transferred funds out of the account).

The Opportunity

Lower the number of TurboTax customers who:

- Take refund advance
- Open a Credit Karma Money account, and
- Drain it

Increase the number of TurboTax customers who

- Take refund advance

- Open a Credit Karma Money account, and
- Do key actions to get the most out of their Credit Karma account.

The Hypothesis

If we encourage RAD customers to **do key actions during a specific time**, they would be more likely to **not drain** their Credit Karma Money account and **perform key account actions**.

[Photo 3.3_Image_1.png]

The Approach

Understood how RAD and regular Credit Karma members use the account

As part of the discovery stage of this project I worked with product analytics to understand how past **RAD** and **nonRAD** (customers from TurboTax who never took RAD) used the accounts. The product analysis pulled data related to members completing key actions:

- Adding money to account
- Activating their debit card
- Connecting apple or google wallet
- First purchase,
- Opening a save account or credit builder account, and
- Connecting direct deposit.

After reviewing the data, we had a better sense of when members usually took these key actions and in what order.

#understand #empathize #analytics #behavior

Brought the team together to define

I developed and facilitated a cross-functional workshop where I brought design, product marketing, and product management together to brainstorm ideal paths for RAD members. The workshop included great discussion, clear alignment, and next steps to develop high level member journeys.

#define #ideate #brainstorm #collaboration

Mapped out ideal member journeys

I took the results of the workshop and the previous analysis of past actions a member took and developed high level journeys for each member type which included the action we wanted members to take and when we wanted them to do it.

#define

Designed a new in-product experience

At the time the account included a small section for next steps with minimal logic. It wasn't very prominent and was missing key actions we wanted the member to take. As part of this experiment I designed a new section using existing design system components which included:

- A large visual encouraging a specific action
- A list with description text and key symbols for status, and
- Link outs to areas of the apps where they could get more information about the action before they took it

The section changed based on the action the member took or specific time that has passed.

[FTUE_How_it_works.pdf]

Gathered member feedback

Partnering with content design and research, we did 2 unmoderated UserTesting sessions.

The learning objectives were to:

- Understand members perception of onboarding and account setup
- Identify ways to improve onboarding, and
- Identify opportunities to improve section copy

The results helped us improve the experience and gave us new ideas to explore.

What we learned

[FTUE_Member_Research.pdf]

#prototype #test #ideate #feedback

Connected in-product experiences with email marketing

While doing this work our team identified an opportunity to better align email marketing efforts with the in-product experience. I worked closely with an email marketing partner to

ensure the lifecycle campaigns were closely aligned to what the member would see in the product at a specific time. Although not perfect, this one was the first effort for our line of business to work more collaboratively with our email marketing team.

#implement #alignment

[Photo 3.3_Image_2.png]

Worked closely with engineering to develop

I worked closely with the engineering team to develop the experience. From 1:1 working sessions to extensive testing in app, I took design ownership of the full experience, ensuring what was shipped was what was designed. At the time we did not have a formal or robust design QA process, so this required overcoming technical challenges and working closely with my engineering partners.

#implement

Created a scalable system

This was a complex system that I wanted to make sure would scale. I developed guidance documentation and figma reusable components and shared it with the design team. I wanted any designer to be able to optimize the experience once I moved on to other projects and teams.

#materialize

[Photo 3.3_Image_3.png]

The Result

This was a great win for the team. Orientation reduced draining of the account and increased the number of key actions the RAD member took.

RAD

[Chart format starts]

New Refund Advance Customer

		Purchase	DD Setup	Credit Builder	Savings
Control	3947	78%	3%	7%	14%
Enabled	4079	82%	4%	7%	15%

Lift		+6%	+29%	+5%	+4%
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		Average card purchase	Average External Bank withdraw	Average self deposit	
Control	3947	\$1,722	\$1,277	\$327	
Enabled	4079	\$1,956	\$1,033	\$394	
Lift		+14%	-19%	+20%	

[Chart format ends]

[Chart format starts]

Returning Refund Advance Customer

		Purchase	DD Setup	Credit Builder	Savings
Control	4203	87%	4%	6%	9%
Enabled	4337	88%	4%	6%	10%
Lift		+1%	-11%	-10%	+10%

		Average card purchase	Average External Bank withdraw	Average self deposit	
Control	4203	\$2,425	\$1,011	\$878	
Enabled	4337	\$2,477	\$949	\$906	
Lift		+2%	-6%	+3%	

[Chart format ends]

It was so successful for RAD members, we decided to roll it out to all members as is.

[Chart format starts]

NonRad New Customer

		Purchase	DD Setup	Credit Builder	Savings
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Control	30,269	28	2%	4%	7%
Enabled	30,080	29	2%	3%	7%
		+3%	-8%	-13%	+5%

		Average card purchase	Average External Bank withdraw	Average self deposit	
Control	30,269	\$388	\$286	\$110	
Enabled	30,080	\$397	\$298	\$108	
		+2%	+4%	-1%	

[Chart format ends]

[Chart format starts]

Returning Refund Advance Customer

		Purchase	DD Setup	Credit Builder	Savings
Control	31,875	66%	2%	3%	5%
Enabled	31,735	66%	2%	3%	5%
		0%	+5%	-4%	+5%

		Average card purchase	Average External Bank withdraw	Average self deposit	
Control	31,875	\$1,452	\$730	\$1,050	
Enabled	31,735	\$1,469	\$719	\$1,083	
		+1%	-1%	+3%	

[Chart format ends]

As you can see, although the results were great for some actions, not all were positive. The opportunity here was to go back to the original strategy and perform a similar activity of mapping out the journey for members who were not RAD members.

4.0 Leadership

Leadership

I'm a nurturing player-coach design leader that leads with both conviction and care.

I believe leadership isn't defined by titles or org charts—it's defined by how people experience working with you. The principles below reflect how I strive to lead every day: creating consistency, communicating with clarity, and leading with care. These principles shape how I build trust, support my teams, and help designers do the best work of their careers.

Consistent

I create consistency that helps teams do their best work.

I believe great teams thrive on predictable rhythms, not constant surprises. I believe consistency builds trust, reduces uncertainty, and gives designers the stability they need to focus on meaningful work.

How I do it:

- Maintain regular, protected 1:1s.
- Establish design critiques and team rituals.
- Follow through on commitments and closing the loop.
- Provide continuous feedback, not just during performance reviews.
- Reinforce expectations through repeatable operating principles.
- Celebrate wins and recognize progress consistently.
- Remain steady and present during periods of change.

Clear

I communicate with clarity so teams can move with confidence.

I believe clarity creates alignment. I strive to make expectations, priorities, and decisions easy to understand so teams can spend less time navigating ambiguity and more time creating impact.

How I do it:

- Share the “why” behind decisions.
- Set clear expectations for quality, ownership, and outcomes.
- Give direct, kind, and actionable feedback.
- Make priorities visible and easy to understand.
- Simplify complex challenges into actionable next steps.
- Encourage healthy discussion while making timely decisions.
- Document key decisions to keep teams aligned.
- Connect design work to customer and business outcomes.

Care

I lead with care because great products are built by people first.

I believe the strongest teams are built on trust, empathy, and genuine investment in one another. Supporting the well-being and growth of the people behind the work is one of my highest responsibilities as a leader.

How I do it:

- Invest in individual career growth and long-term development.
- Foster psychological safety where people feel comfortable sharing ideas and concerns.
- Coach through challenges rather than simply providing answers.
- Recognize individual strengths and create opportunities to build on them.
- Advocate for sustainable workloads and healthy work-life balance.
- Remove obstacles so designers can focus on meaningful work.
- Celebrate progress as much as outcomes.
- Lead with empathy, honesty, and respect.

My stance on AI

I believe every design leader has a responsibility to help their team build confidence with AI. I foster a culture of experimentation, encouraging designers to thoughtfully adopt AI tools that improve efficiency, enhance creativity, and remove friction from the product development process. At the same time, I believe our responsibility as designers is to ensure every decision remains rooted in human needs, research, and thoughtful design. AI is a powerful partner, but human judgment remains essential to validate decisions, refine outcomes, and ensure every experience is intentional, inclusive, and held to the highest standard.